

Miners Raise Baseball Record To 21-8



JIM SACCO
... aids Miners

By **MARK LEIBSON**
Times Sports Writer

"What else could you ask out of one ball player?" said University of Texas at El Paso coach Andy Cohen of senior Bob Alsup. "He did everything we could have possibly asked."

Without Alsup, the Miners probably would not have swept a doubleheader 7-5 and 3-2 from Southern Colorado Friday at Cruz Blanca Stadium in Juarez.

First of all, the left-hander pulled a single to right in the bottom of the sixth inning in the opener, breaking a 5-5 deadlock. An inning later, Alsup was called to the mound from center-field when K.C. Nix, who relieved Russ Bortell in the third, ran into trouble.

Alsup, without having time to warm up like most relievers, retired three consecutive Indians after Nix had allowed a runner to reach third base with no outs.

In the nightcap, Alsup broke a 2-2

tie in the eighth with a towering two-out triple to right-center field, scoring shortstop Orlando Cordova from first.

"Man, all I was trying to do was get a piece of the ball because he (Tim Lee) hadn't thrown me a fastball the whole game and I never got it out of the infield," said Alsup. "He finally gave me the kind of pitch I wanted."

The twin victory boosted UTEP's record to 21-8 heading into Tuesday's doubleheader against New Mexico State at Dudley Field. Southern Colorado fell to 6-11.

The first game was a see-saw battle with the Indians taking a 1-0 lead in the second before the Miners knotted it in their half of the frame. Southern Colorado scored two in the third but UTEP came back with three and added one in the fourth.

A two-run rally in the fifth by the Indians tied the score but UTEP responded with two runs of its own. Art Bravo bunted his way to first and raced to third when pitcher Dave Sis-

sion threw the ball past first.

Alsup broke the deadlock with a single to right, stole second and scored UTEP's insurance run on Rich Hildebrand's single.

The second game developed into a pitcher's battle between Lee and UTEP's Jim Sacco. UTEP tagged Lee for a pair of runs in the third on three straight singles and a run-producing ground out by Alsup.

Southern Colorado scored single tallies in the first and fourth and filled the bases in the fifth before Sacco, now 3-2 for the year, struck out Dave Fobes to end the threat.

First Game
UTEP 7, S. Colorado 5
012 002 0-5 8 1
013 102 2-7 8 0

Manly, Manly - Mike Wise (2), Dave Sisson (1) and Rudi - Kelley, Russ Bortell, K.C. Nix (3), Bob Alsup (7) and Rich Hildebrand. W Nix (7-3); L Sisson (1-1).

Second Game
UTEP 3, S. Colorado 2 (8 Innings)
100 100 00-2 4 1
002 006 01-1 8 3

Tim Lee and John Soricelli; Jim Sacco and Sal Flores. Rich Hildebrand (7); W Sacco (3-2); L Lee (1-1).